

Chaoyi Zhao 赵朝熠

Updated September 1, 2026

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Sloan School of Management
Cambridge, MA, USA

Email: cy_zhao@mit.edu

Homepage: <https://zhaochaoyi.github.io/>

Affiliations	Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Sloan School of Management	MA, USA
	Postdoctoral Associate, MIT Laboratory for Financial Engineering	2024 – Present
	– Advisor: Prof. Andrew W. Lo	
	Society of Actuaries	
	Fellow (FSA, SOA)	2024 – Present
	Associate (ASA, SOA)	2023 – 2024
Research Interests	Investments: Portfolio theory, Factor investing, Market microstructure	
	Statistics: High-dimensional statistics, Machine learning, Artificial intelligence	
	Actuarial Sciences: Copula theory, Term structure modeling	
Education	Peking University, School of Mathematical Sciences	Beijing, China
	Ph.D. in Statistics	Sep 2019 – Jan 2024
	– Advisors: Prof. Lan Wu and Prof. Ruixun Zhang	
	– Completed six months ahead of schedule	
	Peking University, School of Mathematical Sciences	Beijing, China
	B.S. in Mathematics and Applied Mathematics	Sep 2015 – Jul 2019
	– Elite Undergraduate Program of Applied Mathematics	Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
	Peking University, School of EECS	Beijing, China
	B.S. (Double Degree) in Computer Science and Technology	Sep 2016 – Jul 2019
Honors	Awards	
	Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award (Peking University)	2024
	Beijing Outstanding Graduate	2019, 2024
	Excellent Graduate (Peking University)	2019, 2024
	Merit Student (Peking University)	2016, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
	S&P Global Academic ESG Research Award	2022
	Second place in the Best Paper Prize for Young Scholars, Annual Conference of the Operations Research Society of China (Financial Engineering and Risk Management Branch)	2022
	Excellent Graduate of the Elite Undergraduate Program of Applied Mathematics	2019
	The Student of The Year (10 students per year, Peking University)	2018
	Merit Student Pacesetter (Peking University)	2018
	Beijing Merit Student	2018
	Excellent Student Leader (Peking University)	2017

Scholarships

National Scholarship	2018, 2023
President Scholarship (Peking University)	2019, 2020, 2021, 2022
Leo KoGuan Scholarship (Peking University)	2022
Huatai Science and Technology Scholarship (Peking University)	2021
CETC the 14th Research Institute Glarun Scholarship (Peking University)	2020
The National Southwest Associated University Scholarship (Peking University)	2018
Shenzhen Finance Institute Scholarship (the Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen)	2017
Founder Scholarship (Peking University)	2016

Publications

Alphabetical order; * Corresponding author.

Portfolio Theory and Investing

1. The Health of Nations Fund: Financing Global Drug Development
Joonhyuk Cho, Manish Singh, Chaoyi Zhao, Shomesh E. Chaudhuri, and Andrew W. Lo.
PLOS Global Public Health, 6(6), e0005248, 2026. [[PDF](#)][[Appendix](#)][[Journal](#)]
2. High-Frequency Liquidity in the Chinese Stock Market: Measurements, Patterns, and Determinants
Chaoyi Zhao, Yufan Chen, Lintong Wu, Yuehao Dai, Ermo Chen, Lan Wu, and Ruixun Zhang.
Pacific-Basin Finance Journal, 90, 102681, 2025. [[PDF](#)][[Appendix](#)][[Journal](#)]
3. Optimal Impact Portfolios with General Dependence and Marginals
Andrew W. Lo, Lan Wu, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
Operations Research, 72(5), 1775–1789, 2024. [[PDF](#)][[Appendix](#)][[Journal](#)]
– Second place in the Best Paper Prize for Young Scholars, Annual Conference of the Operations Research Society of China (Financial Engineering and Risk Management Branch).
– Reported by [Center for Statistical Science](#), Peking University.
4. Measuring and Optimizing the Risk and Reward of Green Portfolios
Andrew W. Lo, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
The Journal of Impact and ESG Investing, 3(2), 55–93, 2022. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]
– Winner of the [S&P Global Academic ESG Research Award](#).
– Reported by [Practical Applications](#) [[PDF](#)].
– Reported by [Center for Statistical Science](#) and [School of Mathematical Sciences](#), Peking University.
5. Order Types and Natural Price Change: Model and Empirical Study of the Chinese Market
Siyu Liu, Chaoyi Zhao*, and Lan Wu.
International Journal of Financial Engineering, 9(04), 2250033, 2022. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]

High-Dimensional Statistics, Machine Learning, and Artificial Intelligence

6. Estimating and Predicting Clinical Trial Outcomes in China
Chaoyi Zhao*, Timothy Pang, and Andrew W. Lo.
Drug Discovery Today, forthcoming, 2026.
7. Interpretable Image-Based Deep Learning for Price Trend Prediction in ETF Markets
Ruixun Zhang, Chaoyi Zhao, and Guanglian Lin.
The European Journal of Finance, 32(13), 1598–1626, 2026. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]

8. On Consistency of Signature Using Lasso
Xin Guo, Binnan Wang, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
Operations Research, 73(5), 2530–2549, 2025. [[PDF](#)][[Appendix](#)][[Journal](#)]
– Reported by [Center for Statistical Science](#), Peking University.
9. The Evolution of Discrimination Under Finite Memory Constraints
Andrew W. Lo, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
Scientific Reports, 15, 31774, 2025. [[PDF](#)] [[Appendix](#)] [[Journal](#)]
10. The Success of AdaBoost and its Application in Portfolio Management
Yijian Chuan, Chaoyi Zhao, Zhenrui He, and Lan Wu.
International Journal of Financial Engineering, 8(02), 2142001, 2021. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]

Actuarial Sciences

11. The Checkerboard Copula and Dependence Concepts
Liyuan Lin, Ruodu Wang, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao[#].
SIAM Journal on Financial Mathematics, 16(2), 426–447, 2025. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]
12. Construct Smith–Wilson Risk-Free Interest Rate Curves with Endogenous and Positive Ultimate Forward Rates
Chaoyi Zhao^{*}, Zijian Jia, and Lan Wu.
Insurance: Mathematics and Economics, 114, 156–175, 2024. [[PDF](#)][[Journal](#)]

Books

13. 量化投资 (Quantitative Investment)
Jian Sun, Lan Wu, and Chaoyi Zhao.
Science Press, 2023. [[Link](#)]
14. 金融市场风险管理分析 (Financial Market Risk Management Analytics)
Frank H. Koger. Translated by Chaoyi Zhao.
Truth & Wisdom Press, 2022. [[Link](#)]
15. 数学百科 (The Maths Book)
Dorling Kindersley Ltd. Translated by Chaoyi Zhao.
Publishing House of Electronics Industry, 2021. [[Link](#)]

Doctoral Dissertation

16. 高维多因子模型与伴随次序统计量的随机模型与统计分析 (Stochastic Models and Statistical Analysis for High-dimensional Multi-factor Models and Induced Order Statistics)
Chaoyi Zhao.
Doctoral Dissertation in Statistics, Peking University, 2024.

Preprints

17. No Asset Is an Island: A Real Options Framework for Valuing Interdependent Projects
Shomesh E. Chaudhuri, Andrew W. Lo, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
Under review.
18. Optimal Multi-Period Dynamic Portfolios for Sustainable Investing
Danping Li, Ruixun Zhang, and Chaoyi Zhao^{#*}.
Under review. [[SSRN](#)]

19. Underperformance of Performance Shares
Marc Hodak, Andrew W. Lo, Austin Starkweather, and Chaoyi Zhao[#].
Working paper. [[SSRN](#)]
20. Breaking the Factor Zootopia: Factor Selection via Significant Tests of Multi-Task Lasso
Chaoyi Zhao* and Lan Wu.
Working paper.

Research Projects

Data-driven Financial Risk Forecasting	
National Key R&D Program of China, participant	2023 – 2024
Portfolio Analytics and Risk Management for Green Investing: Theory and Application	
National Natural Science Foundation of China, participant	2023 – 2024
High-Frequency T+0 Quantitative Trading Strategy Based on Deep Learning	
Peking University and Founder Securities, participant	2019 – 2020
Gradient Optimization Model Based on Genetic Programming	
Ernst & Young (China) Advisor Ltd, intern	2019
Multi-Factor Alpha Strategy Based on the AdaBoost Algorithm	
Peking University and Founder Securities, participant	2018 – 2019
Application of Statistical Learning in Modeling the Relationship Between Stock Index and Futures	
Peking University, undergraduate research, group leader	2017 – 2018

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant at Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
<i>15.C51 Modeling with Machine Learning: Financial Technology</i>	Spring 2026
Elective for Graduate Students. Instructors: Prof. Andrew W. Lo and Prof. Paul F. Mende	
<i>15.482 Healthcare Finance</i>	Fall 2024
Elective for Graduate and Senior Undergraduate Students. Instructor: Prof. Andrew W. Lo	
Teaching Assistant at Peking University	
<i>Quantitative Trading</i>	Fall 2020, 2022
Elective for Graduate and Senior Undergraduate Students. Instructors: Prof. Jian Sun and Lan Wu	
<i>Practice for Fixed Income Securities</i>	Fall 2021, 2022
Elective for Graduate and Senior Undergraduate Students. Instructors: Prof. Lan Wu <i>et al.</i>	
<i>Theory and Practice for Futures and Other Derivatives</i>	Spring 2022
Elective for Graduate and Senior Undergraduate Students. Instructors: Prof. Lan Wu <i>et al.</i>	
<i>Mathematical Analysis III (Including Exercise Class)</i>	Fall 2021
Core Class for Undergraduate Students. Instructor: Prof. Jiazhong Yang	
<i>Mathematical Analysis II (Including Exercise Class)</i>	Spring 2021
Core Class for Undergraduate Students. Instructor: Prof. Jiazhong Yang	
<i>Risk Management and Financial Regulation</i>	Spring 2021
Core Class for Graduate Students. Instructor: Prof. Lan Wu	
<i>Exercise Class for Probability and Statistics</i>	Spring 2020
Elective for Undergraduate Students.	

Talks**Valuation and Portfolio Theory for Biomedical Investments***2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting*

Nov 1–4, 2026

2026 INFORMS Healthcare Conference

Jul 29, 2026

No Asset Is an Island: A Real Options Framework for Valuing Interdependent Projects*Peking University Seminar*

Sep 18, 2025

On Consistency of Signature Using Lasso*SIAM Conference on Financial Mathematics and Engineering (FM25)*

Jul 15, 2025

(Session Chair) 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting

Oct 22, 2024

CSIAM 2023

Oct 15, 2023

UC Berkeley Seminar

May 7, 2023

Breaking the Factor Zootopia: Factor Selection via Significant Tests of Multi-Task Lasso*7th PKU-NUS Annual International Conference on Quantitative Finance and Economics*

May 20, 2023

Peking University Seminar

Apr 21, 2023

CSIAM Financial Math Annual Conference

Nov 13, 2022

Optimal Impact Portfolios with General Dependence and Marginals*ICIAM 2023*

Aug 20–25, 2023

The 11th Annual Conference of the Operations Research Society of China (Financial Engineering and Risk Management Branch)

Dec 10, 2022

– Second place in the Best Paper Prize for Young Scholars

Sun Yat-sen University Seminar

Nov 4, 2022

The 19th Chinese Finance Annual Meeting

Oct 30, 2022

High-Frequency Liquidity in the Chinese Stock Market: Measurements, Patterns, and Determinants*China Finance Review International & China International Risk Forum Joint Conference*

Jul 29, 2023

CSIAM Financial Math Annual Conference

Nov 12, 2022

IFZ FinTech Colloquium 2022, Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Arts

Nov 2, 2022

2022 INFORMS Annual Meeting

Oct 17, 2022

(Session Chair) 11th World Congress of Bachelier Finance Society

Jun 15, 2022

Construct Smith–Wilson Interest Rate Curves with Endogenous Ultimate Forward Rates*United As One: 24th International Congress on Insurance: Mathematics and Economics*

Jun 5, 2021

Statistical Patterns of High-Frequency Data for A-share stocks in Shenzhen Stock Exchange*3rd Seminar for Young Scholars in Financial Engineering and Risk Management*

Jun 12, 2021

Discussions*2025 MRS International Risk Conference*

Jul 26, 2025

Non-Academic Talks*Workshop: Creating a Personal Financial Planning Web App*– MIT AI Educators Pilot [[Link](#)]

Jul 16, 2026

– MIT Executive Education Program [[Link](#)]

Jul 24, 2026

Speech for the Opening Ceremony of School of Mathematical Sciences, Peking University

– Representative of seniors [[Link](#)]

Sep 15, 2018

**Academic
Services**

Referee Service

ASTIN Bulletin, IEEE Transactions on Circuits and Systems for Video Technology, IEEE Transactions on Multimedia, Insurance: Mathematics and Economics, Journal of Financial Data Science, Journal of Mathematical Economics, Management Science, North American Actuarial Journal, Operations Research

Skills

Programming: Python, R, C/C++, MATLAB, Java, SQL

Languages: Mandarin Chinese, English

Hobbies: Swimming, Rowing, Hiking, Bouldering, Stand-up Comedy